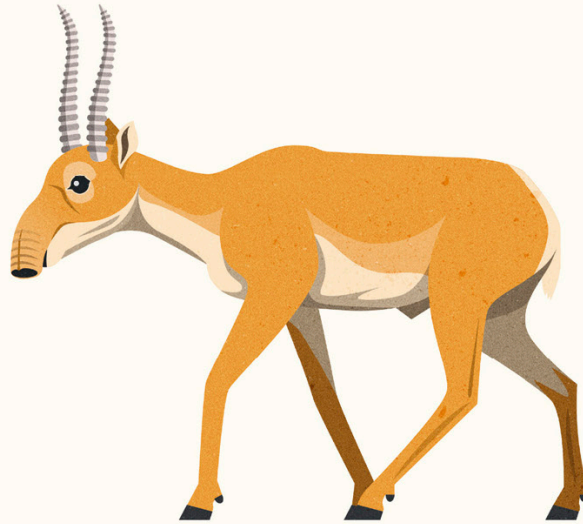


Saiga



Somewhere, out in the sea of golden grass, the saigas are hiding. These weird-looking animals live on vast plains, called steppes, which stretch across the centre of Asia. It's hard to spot their herds, because they are always on the move. Each year, saigas travel huge distances in search of fresh grass to eat. Only the male saiga has horns; however, both males and females have huge, droopy noses. This stretched snout helps the saiga control its body temperature by warming the air it breathes in or cooling its blood.

There used to be millions of saigas, but hunting by humans reduced their population to the thousands. Now the species is protected and there are many more, although it is still endangered.

*When it is just two days old, a saiga calf
can already run faster than a human!*